



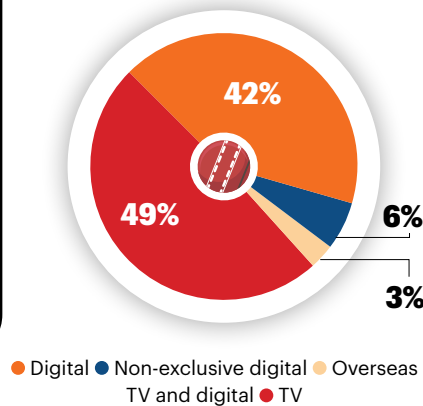
ILLUSTRATION BY NILANJAN DAS

**\$3
BILLION**

**AMOUNT GENERATED
BY AUCTION OF
MEDIA RIGHTS FOR
BROADCAST IN INDIA
REGION OF ALL
ICC MATCHES
PLAYED ANYWHERE
IN THE WORLD**

CASH SPINNER

A look at the break-up of the
₹48,390-crore IPL media rights pie
(Figures are for 2023-27)



channels, but “one must understand the rates that come with it are also very high”.

Shah’s company is one of the associate sponsors that Disney Star signed on for this year’s IPL. In a year when some of the high-profile start-ups/unicorns (like BYJU’S and Livspace) were conspicuous by their absence, he got an “attractive rate”, says Shah, without getting into details. In 2022,

when Disney Star had both the TV and digital rights, it is said to have raked in ₹3,500 crore by way of advertising revenue—₹2,900 crore through television and ₹600 crore on Disney+ Hotstar, its OTT platform. For 2023-27, more than ₹9,000 crore will need to be made each year by those holding the media rights—just to recoup their investment. Those like Shah are not willing to commit right away for the ICC Men’s Cricket World Cup 2023 (ODI) to be held in India. “Benchmarks will obviously change and we need to take a close look at how much money we are left with,” he says. From a broadcaster’s point of view, the IPL also serves as an audience funnel

for other cricket properties and even other sports. Disney Star’s Gupta outlines how the network leveraged the IPL to promote the ICC World Test Championship (WTC) as well as entertainment properties including movie and show launches. “A robust cricket portfolio allows us to stay connected to the cricket fan and keep him on a journey with the network. During the WTC final, we will promote